City of Cambridge

RES 2026-130
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 28, 2026

COUNCILLOR SIMMONS

WHEREAS: The MIT/Wellesley Upward Bound Program celebrates its 60th anniversary in 2026, marking six decades of expanding educational opportunity for students from Cambridge and surrounding communities; and

WHEREAS: The program began in 1965 as the MIT Science Day Camp, established to bring college preparation and academic enrichment to underrepresented young people across Greater Boston, and in 1966 MIT received one of the nation's earliest federal Upward Bound grants under the Economic Opportunity Act of 1964, part of the Johnson Administration's broader effort to confront poverty and widen access to education; and

WHEREAS: Wellesley College joined the effort during the 1968-1969 academic year, and in June 1969 the program adopted the name "MIT/Wellesley Upward Bound Program," forging a partnership between two distinguished institutions that endures to this day; and

WHEREAS: The program has opened the doors of higher education to generations of students from low-income families and to students who will be the first in their families to attend college, pairing academic support, mentoring, and enrichment with the individualized guidance that carries young people through high school and on to success in college; and

WHEREAS: The program today serves approximately 60 students in grades 9 – 12 who live in Cambridge or attend school in Cambridge, offering year-round support through academic-year programming at MIT and an intensive six-week residential summer experience at Wellesley College; and

WHEREAS: For generations of Cambridge students and families, the program has been a vital pathway to opportunity, sharpening academic skills, building confidence, demystifying the college application process, and helping young people see futures they might never have believed were within reach; and

WHEREAS: For six decades, the MIT/Wellesley Upward Bound Program has helped generations of Cambridge students see higher education as an attainable goal, reflecting the enduring commitment of MIT, Wellesley College, program staff, families, alumni, and community partners to expanding opportunity and investing in the potential of young people; now therefore be it

RESOLVED: That the Cambridge City Council go on record recognizing and celebrating the 60th Anniversary of the MIT/Wellesley Upward Bound Program, and commending the

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Wellesley College, and all who have contributed to its six decades of service to Cambridge students and families; and be it further

RESOLVED: That the City Council go on record extending its congratulations and best wishes to the program's current students, alumni, families, staff, faculty, educators, volunteers, community partners, and supporters as they mark this historic milestone and carry forward their work to expand college access for future generations; and be it further

RESOLVED: That the City Clerk be and hereby is requested to forward a suitably engrossed copy of this resolution to Evette M. Layne, Director of Educational Opportunity Programs at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, for the MIT/Wellesley Upward Bound Program, on behalf of the entire City Council.

A true copy;

ATTEST:- 

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk

City of Cambridge

Resolution congratulating the MIT/Wellesley Upward Bound Program on its 60th Anniversary.